Research Report

DPDP Act, GDPR basics and everyday privacy risks for students

Prepared: 22 October 2026 | **Audience:** college students and student-club volunteers

1. Project question

How can AI help explain data privacy rights and responsibilities in simple language for students?

2. Why this audience

Students share personal data all day: app permissions, registration forms for fests and workshops, ID copies, public Wi-Fi logins and AI chatbots. Club volunteers also collect other students' names and phone numbers, which makes them handlers of personal data too. Most have never read a privacy notice, so plain language is the main need.

3. Method

- Searched the live web with an AI assistant (Claude) for the DPDP Rules 2025 timeline, the Act's rights, penalties and children's provisions, and the CERT-In incident reporting rule.
- Preferred government-linked and law-firm sources. Where sources disagreed, the conflict was logged in the Verification Report (file 10).
- Turned the verified findings into the explainer, scenarios, checklist, quiz, infographic, slides and the website.

AI tool	Used for
Claude	Web research, source comparison, drafting, quiz design, website code, slides, infographic and documents

Additional free tools (for example Perplexity, NotebookLM, ChatGPT, Gamma) can be used to cross-check these findings; prompts for this are in the Prompt Library (file 9).

4. Key findings

Topic	Finding
Law and dates	DPDP Act passed 11 Aug 2023. DPDP Rules, 2025 notified 13 Nov 2025 (G.S.R. 843(E)). Board provisions: immediate. Consent managers: about 13 Nov 2026. Rights, children's rules and penalties: about 13 May 2027.
Roles	You are the Data Principal. The organisation deciding how your data is used is the Data Fiduciary.
Consent	Must be free, specific, informed, unconditional and unambiguous, with a clear affirmative action. It can be withdrawn, and withdrawing must be as easy as giving it (Section 6).
Your rights	Information (S.11), correction and erasure (S.12), grievance redressal (S.13), nomination (S.14). Duties of the Data Principal: S.15.
Children	Under 18: verifiable parental consent; no tracking, behavioural monitoring or targeted ads directed at children (S.9).
Penalties	Up to ₹250 crore for failing to keep reasonable security safeguards (S.8(5)). Up to ₹200 crore each for failing to report a breach (S.8(6)) and for breaching children's obligations (S.9), as listed in the Schedule. Confirm amounts in the Act text.
GDPR basics	In force since 2018. Rights include access, rectification, erasure, restriction, portability and objection. Fines up to €20 million or 4% of worldwide turnover, whichever is higher. Breach notice to the authority within 72 hours.
CERT-In	Since the 28 April 2022 directions (effective 27 June 2022), service providers, body corporates and government bodies must report listed cyber incidents to CERT-In within 6 hours of noticing them.

5. Everyday privacy risks for students

- Apps asking for contacts, location or microphone access that they do not need.
- Forms that ask for Aadhaar or other IDs when a college ID would do.
- Pre-ticked marketing or data-sharing boxes.
- Public Wi-Fi logins and unknown links or QR codes.
- Pasting real marksheets, IDs or photos into AI chatbots.
- Apps that keep your data after you stop using them.

6. Reliability of sources

Several web pages disagreed on section numbers and on some penalty amounts, and at least one guide called the Act "fully operational" although the rights and penalty sections are not due until about May 2027. Details are in the Verification Report. Only points that matched across sources, or the Act's own structure, were kept.

7. Conclusion

AI is useful for turning legal text into simple language, building scenarios and quizzes, and drafting reminders. It is not a lawyer. Every date, section number and penalty must be checked against the gazette text on the MeitY website before it is repeated.

Sources

- MeitY: Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (official text): https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2024/06/2bf1f0e9f04e6fb4f8fef35e82c42aa5.pdf
- JSA Prism, DPDP Rules 2025 timeline: https://www.jsalaw.com/?p=55573
- Bar and Bench, DPDP Rules 2025 overview: https://www.barandbench.com/view-point/meity-notifies-final-digital-personal-data-protection-rules-2025
- Deccan Herald, 14 Nov 2025 report on the notified Rules: https://www.deccanherald.com/india/centre-notifies-dpdp-rules-implementation-planned-in-phases-spread-over-12-18-months-3798465
- Linklaters, CERT-In 2022 directions: https://www.linklaters.com/en/insights/blogs/digilinks/2022/may/india-new-and-onerous-cyber-security-framework-and-breach-reporting-obligations
- EU GDPR official text (EUR-Lex): https://eur-lex.europa.eu